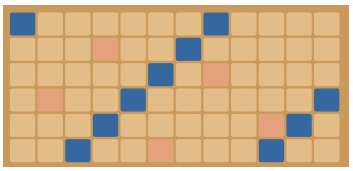
Wordwright: How to Play



Wordwright is a crossword game for 2 to 4 players. Build words on the board from your rack of seven letter tiles; every word you make or extend scores.

Your turn

- **Play:** put one or more tiles in a single row or column, with no gaps, so they join tiles already on the board. The very first word must cover the ★ in the middle and use at least two tiles.
- **Swap tiles:** return some tiles to the bag and draw the same number (only while the bag holds at least 7). You score nothing.
- **Pass:** do nothing this turn.
- **Resign:** leave this match at any time. Your unplayed tiles are deducted from your score, then returned to the bag. Your score is frozen and your turns are skipped. If only one player remains, that player wins immediately.

To place a tile, tap it on your rack and then tap a square, or drag it there. Drag tiles between rack slots to sort them, or tap Arrange tiles and then tap a tile and its new position. Sorting stays in this browser and does not use a turn. Take back placed tiles before sorting. With a keyboard, move to a square with the arrow keys and type letters. Tap a tile you placed (or press Backspace) to take it back. The line under your rack shows what the move would score before you commit it. Your unplayed tiles stay put while other people move, unless the board changes under them.

Scoring

- Each tile shows its points. A **blank** (dashed outline) can be any letter you choose and is worth 0.
- Coloured squares count only when you place a new tile on them: **2× letter** and **3× letter** multiply that tile; **2× word** and **3× word** (and the ★, which is 2× word) multiply the whole word. Two word squares in one word multiply together.
- Every new word your tiles form counts, including words made across.
- Use all seven tiles in one turn for **50 extra points**.

The end

- The game ends when someone uses their last tile after the bag is empty, or after six scoreless turns in a row (passes, swaps, or plays worth 0).
- Everyone loses the points on the tiles left on their rack. If someone went out, they gain all of those points. These adjustments are listed at the end of the game.
- Among players who have not resigned, highest score wins; equal top scores tie.
- When the board is stuck, players can Pass until six scoreless turns end the game with normal scoring. Abandon match ends it early without a winner.

Table options

- **Check words against the word list** (on by default) uses the public-domain ENABLE list, plus a few common two-letter words, downloaded once by the group's installation. Turn it off to let players decide among themselves.
- **Board** changes only the picture. The drawn board follows the table's look; the artwork boards are optional pictures that an installation may leave out.